Actual jihad was unleashed by Syed Ahmed Shaheed Barelvi from Patna (India) in 1826. Syed Ahmed and Syed Ismail established their government in Charsadda (Khyber Pakhtunkhwa), and the number of their followers swelled to 100,000. However, ultimately, they had to face tough resistance from Sikhs and some local tribes and, ultimately, both died in a battle with Sikhs on 6 May 1831 (Qazi, 2011). It should be pointed out that Malakand and surrounding areas, which was the hub of Fazlullah-led terrorism in quest for the Islamic system in 2008–9, were the same area where Syed Ahmed had carried out his Jihad. As Lieven (2011) writes, 'He (Syed Ahmed Barelvi) is remembered by jihadi Islamists in the region as the greatest progenitor of their tradition.'

Although the British considered these repeated revolts as restricted to Pathan areas, without seriously fearing its spill over to other areas of the Indian empire (Lieven, 2011), they were wary of these experiences. Therefore, they believed that the Muslim leadership of India converted a sepoy mutiny into a war of independence in 1857 (Metcalf, 1965).

Nevertheless, they treated the Muslims ruthlessly, especially the ruling elite (Singh, 2009). According to Mahmood (2000):

> As far back as 1842, Lord Ellenborough had written to the Duke of Wellington that the Muslims were fundamentally hostile towards the British and that their enmity towards the government was an established fact. But the collapse of the "war of Independence" in 1857, with its storm centres in the Muslim areas of Delhi and Oudh, further darkened the Muslims' prospects.

These circumstances led to the birth of Islamic reformist movements. Sir Syed Ahmed Khan, a Muslim thinker, writer, educationist and reformist, asserted that Muslims were a separate nation and started the struggle for their educational uplift. Although his tone was reconciliatory and reformist, which urged the Muslims to befriend the British, he laid emphasis on the separate identity of the Muslims of India. He was a religious but pragmatic visionary. Lieven (2011) describes him and his approach quite befittingly:

> Although himself a deeply religious man, Sir Syed advocated the need for Indian Muslims to collaborate with the British, and to learn the ways of Western modernity in order to develop as a